Dan Hammer

Renaissance Philanthropy, Fellow
Harvard University, Affiliate
National Geographic Fellow

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Education

PhD and MS, Environmental Economics, University of California, Berkeley (2017)

BA, Mathematics and Economics, with High Honors, Swarthmore College (2007)

Grants and Awards

Webby Awards, 4x (2024–2026)

Planetary Steward, TEDxBoston (2023)

Anthem Awards, Sustainability & Environment (2022, 2024)

Mark Bingham Award for Excellence in Achievement by a Young Alumnus, UC Berkeley (2019)

National Geographic Fellow (2018)

Pritzker Environmental Genius Award (2017)

Keynote Address to the California Water Resources Control Board (2017)

Summer at Census Scholar (2017)

Berkeley Institute for Data Science Fellowship (2015)

Presidential Innovation Fellowship (2014)

Graduate Student Researcher Appointment, UC Berkeley (2011)

Honorable Mention, National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (2011)

First Place, University of Maryland graduate research competition, Earth and ocean science (2010)

Thomas J. Watson Fellowship (2007)

Lang Opportunity Scholarship (2003) and Fellowship for graduate studies (2006)

Work Experience

LGND, Co-founder & Chief Product Officer

Building the infrastructure and algorithms to make pretrained transformers for Earth observation useful in end-use applications.

Renaissance Philanthropy, Fellow

Developing a fund to assess the progress of frontier AI against social benchmarks.

Harvard Law School Library, Affiliate, Institutional Data Initiative

Making satellite imagery, maps, and other Earth observation data more accessible for AI-assisted research, and exploring how maps and boundaries shape our understanding of place and history in cultural heritage.

Clay, Co-founder

An open-source, nonprofit AI model trained on global satellite imagery to measure and monitor how Earth is changing. Funded by Schmidt Futures, the Grantham Foundation, and AWS.

Ode, Co-founder & Managing Partner (2024)

An engineering and design agency building digital products that make environmental data intuitive, actionable, and inspiring. Recognized with 4x Webby and 5x Anthem Awards, Ode partners with AWS, the Jane Goodall Institute, Carbon Mapper, and The Margin.

Earthrise Media & **The Earth Genome**, Co-founder

A nonprofit project with the mission of telling stories about environmental and humanitarian events through satellite imagery. Partners included National Geographic, Reuters, XPRIZE, Climate TRACE, and X (Google).

X (Google), Senior Advisor & Climate Fellow

Advising on environmental data strategy at X, Google's moonshot factory, for projects ranging from Elemental Labs to Bellwether (formerly Greensight).

National Geographic Society, Senior Advisor & Fellow

Advising National Geographic Labs on strategic investment in conservation technology, reporting to the Vice President of Technology.

The White House, Office of Science and Technology Policy, Senior Policy Advisor

Advised the Chief Technology Officer of the United States (Megan Smith) on the public finance of data infrastructure and supported the civic tech community (e.g., the U.S. Digital Service, 18F, and Presidential Innovation Fellows).

NASA, Presidential Innovation Fellow

Selected as one of 23 fellows from over 2,100 applicants for a White House program to facilitate innovation, broadly defined, within federal agencies. Worked with the Office of the Chief Information Officer (OCIO) to prototype service-oriented architecture at NASA. Profile on the White House website.

Berkeley Institute for Data Science, Fellow

The Berkeley Institute for Data Science (BIDS) is a central hub of research and education at UC Berkeley designed to facilitate and nurture data-intensive science.

Global Partnership for Sustainable Development Data, Lead Data Scientist

The Global Partnership for Sustainable Development Data is a global network of governments, NGOs, and businesses working together to strengthen inclusivity, trust, and innovation in the way data is used to address sustainable development. Led a group including Facebook, Harvard, McKinsey, and Planet Labs on the effective use of development data.

SpaceKnow, Chief Scientist

Led data analytics as a co-founder of SpaceKnow through a successful seed round ($1M). Designed algorithms to run on Google's computing and app framework for on-demand analytics on high-resolution satellite imagery.

World Resources Institute, Chief Data Scientist & Research Fellow

Founded the Data Lab at the World Resources Institute. Released Global Forest Watch (GFW) to monitor global deforestation. Developed algorithms to detect and classify structural change in the spectral time series for each 500 m pixel in the tropics. GFW received 250,000 visitors from 171 countries in its first week and was featured in articles from the BBC, The Atlantic, Slate, and NBC, among many others.

Resources for the Future, Affiliated Expert & Research Analyst

Affiliated Expert in the Center for Climate and Electricity Policy. Developed the second release of the Forest Carbon Index (FCI), a public tool to analyze the global distribution of forest carbon resources; built the FCI workflow on Amazon's cloud computing platform.

Center for Global Development, Consultant & Research Assistant

Supported the research of David Wheeler, Nancy Birdsall, and Arvind Subramanian on multiple projects, including the development of a system to track deforestation in near real time at 1 km spatial resolution using NASA satellite imagery.

Academic Positions

Adjunct Professor, University of California, Berkeley

Teaching environmental data analysis and policy analysis in the Haas School of Business, the College of Natural Resources, and the Division of Computing, Data Science, and Society.

Adjunct Professor, Georgetown University

Data Science for Public Policy: evaluating and analyzing public policy, and telling stories with data to make compelling, fact-based arguments.

Adjunct Professor, University of San Francisco

Introduction to Web Mapping: a working knowledge of web-based mapping and spatial SQL queries for a variety of applications, based on the open-source Carto platform. Course materials online.

Graduate Student Instructor, University of California, Berkeley

ARE 212: Multiple Equation Estimation: graduate-level econometrics for upper-division students in Economics, Public Policy, Biostatistics, and other departments. Course materials online.

IAS 106: Undergraduate Microeconomics.

Lead Instructor, San Quentin State Prison

Taught introductory statistics, intermediate algebra, and trigonometry to upper-level incarcerated students seeking an associate's degree through the Prison University Project.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Chami, R., C. Duarte, **D. Hammer**, *et al.* 2026. "Building equitable and nature-positive blue natural capital markets." *Cell Reports Sustainability*, Article 100709. Available online.

Dasgupta, S., **D. Hammer**, R. Kraft, D. Wheeler. 2014. "A Resource Allocation Model for Tiger Habitat Protection." *Journal of Management and Sustainability*, Vol. **4**(3). Available online.

Hammer, D., D. Wheeler, R. Kraft. 2013. "Near real-time forest cover change detection in the humid tropics using MODIS data." *International Journal of Applied Earth Observation and Geoinformation*, Vol. **33**, pp. 1–9. Available online.

Wheeler, D., **D. Hammer**, R. Kraft, S. Dasgupta, B. Blankespoor. 2013. "Economic dynamics and forest clearing: A spatial econometric analysis for Indonesia." *Ecological Economics*, Vol. **85**, pp. 85–96. Available online.

Dasgupta, S., **D. Hammer**, R. Kraft, D. Wheeler. 2012. "Vyaghranomics in Space and Time: Estimating Habitat Threat for Bengal, Indochinese, Malayan and Sumatran Tigers." *Journal of Policy Modeling*, Vol. **36**(3), pp. 433–453. Available online.

Forrest, J., **D. Hammer**, R. Kraft, *et al.* 2011. "Single-species conservation in a multiple-use landscape: Current protection of the tiger range." *Animal Conservation*, Vol. **14**. Available online.